

OnePlus 13R

R for Rebel

OnePlus is back after they went from crushing it with 21% of the market in 2023 to barely scraping by with 6% in 2024. Last year was especially unfavourable for OnePlus even though it made some strides in the ultra-premium foldable segment with its first foldable, the OnePlus Open. In 2025, OnePlus wants to win back all those fans it lost in 2024 and is trying to claw its way back starting the OnePlus 13 series launch. I have been testing the OnePlus 13R for the last two weeks and I'm ready to tell you everything about this device. And trust me, there's a lot to unpack here.



BUILD AND DESIGN

The OnePlus 13R looks and feels quite different from the 12R. While the latter gave us curved edges, an aluminium frame and Gorilla Glass Victus 2, the 13R gets Gorilla Glass 7i on both front and back. Now, it's not as durable as the top-end Victus 2, but that doesn't mean you should worry one bit about daily wear and tear. This isn't just marketing speak. In my two weeks of using the 13R without a case, my review unit is still scratch-free, which is impressive.

The phone comes in two finishes: Astral Trail and Nebula Noir. I feel OnePlus could have gone with a more vibrant shade here as it did with the 12R, but they decided to keep it simple. I've got the Astral Trail variant, and the concentric rings catching light give it a star trail effect with silky-smooth texture.

While I personally think the design is a bit of a letdown considering how well-built the 12R looks and feels, even now! But it's not just always about looks, the matte finish does a fantastic job hiding fingerprints, something the



12R struggled with.

So, if you're a fan of how the 13R looks, there's absolutely nothing wrong with that, it's well built, and has a lot of symmetry going around with a flat frame and display, but if you ask me, I feel the character of the 12R is missing from the 13R. Oh,

and the 13R gets a minute bump in the IP rating. It is now IP65 rated while the 12R is IP64 certified.

DISPLAY

The OnePlus 13R gets a 6.7-inch ProXDR display, and while its specs might sound similar to the 12R, the improvements here are substantial. The screen is capable of producing vivid and sharp visuals with accurate colours. So, if you watch a lot of videos or movies on your phone, the 13R's display takes it to the next level with Dolby Vision and HDR Vivid Support.

In our display tests, the 13R gives a Delta E of 0.8 in the DCI-P3 colour space while the 12R has a Delta E of 1.1. Anything under 1 is essentially perfect for the human eye and this means that both phones are capable of

producing accurate colours, at all times. Our testing also revealed that the 13R's display covers 99% of the DCI-P3 colour gamut while the 12R covers 98% of the gamut. These are pretty good numbers and prove that both phones have great displays for daily use. In our brightness test, the 13R was able to touch 1700 nits of peak brightness in Vivid mode with adaptive brightness enabled. Meanwhile, the 12R's display was also able to go up to 1800 nits of peak brightness. I also tested the 13R against the 12R under direct sunlight, and the 13R intelligently adjusts brightness based on content, not just ambient light. The Aqua Touch 2.0 feature deserves special mention as the screen remains responsive even when wet. The Glove Mode is equally impressive – I could use the phone perfectly while wearing winter gloves up to 0.5 cm thick.

PERFORMANCE

Under the hood, we've got the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3, and while it is not the latest, it is a tried and tested chip that does the job quite well. The base variant starts with 12GB LPDDR5X RAM and 256GB UFS 4.0 storage, while Indian users get an additional 16GB+512GB option.

Be it scrolling past your Instagram feed, watching videos on YouTube or gaming on the go, the OnePlus 13R does it all without any lags or frame drops. My experience with the 13R has remained fluid and in daily use, I could keep over 40 apps in memory without any reloads. Now, I know that's not how most people use their phones, but it just goes on to show the kind of performance you can expect from the 13R.

In multiple runs of CPU throttling tests, the 13R was able to run upto 73 to 79% of its peak potential which indicates that it can sustain performance without compromising on thermals.

Let's talk gaming – the 13R supports 120fps in BGMI without quality compromises. I played a couple of rounds of BGMI, Genshin Impact and COD Mobile but I did not notice any frame